



This article makes us aware of how often we use open source software without even realising it. Aimed at all music lovers, it features a few very basic, commonly used music players for desktops and mobile devices.

When people from a non-tech background talk about open source applications, they assume it is something that's rare or difficult to use. Yet, unknowingly, we extensively use open source applications in our daily lives. If I could draw an analogy, it is similar to non-English-speaking people using English words, without being aware of it.

Music players

To elaborate on my point, let's look at the music players that we use on our computers and mobile devices every day. There are lots of them out there and you'll be pleasantly surprised to learn that most of them are open source.

Naming a few

VLC, MPV, MP Player, SMP, Tomahawk, etc., are a few open source music players, all of which are either written in C, C++ or Objective C, providing extensive support to almost all audio/video file formats. All of these come with very simple but attractive user interfaces. They also provide features like fancy themes, widgets screen, as well as the ability to create and manage music albums, playlists, etc.

Some of the best players

Rating a music player can be tricky and preferences vary widely with every individual. But let's try to pick a few which offer multiple features, various fancy themes

